

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 1

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of upcoming KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

This month we are considering KF Confession 1:

We confess that we have worshiped and served an Idol Self that we have created.

How did we turn from the real God who created us and create a god of our own? In the NHG book study, which we all endured together, we learned that our backgrounds, our conflicts about other people, our deep anxiety, and our need for self-confidence all pressed us into seeking an imagined safe place that required certain behaviors to maintain it. These behaviors seemed to give us some degree of relief from our anxiety, but they still did not provide the security and self-confidence that we dreamed of. We then believed that *more* would be better, so we took those behaviors to an extreme. We dreamed that if we could do them perfectly, we would have what we seek. That dream hardened into a chronic search for glory, an imagined place of perfect security and effortless superiority. We became completely egocentric in this search. We no longer noticed nor took any real interest in other people's struggle with the same problem.

The search for glory uses up a lot of energy. Our goal in Karis Fellowships is to redirect that creative and abundant energy toward our true glory. As we learned in the **KF Introductory Meeting**, this glory reflects our original design as God's creatures and His glory as our Creator. Our glory is this: *to fulfill our design as creatures who uniquely represent God's character in this material world. (Repeat)*

How does the Bible first describe our glory? Let's look at **Genesis 1:26–28**. This translation is from the *New American Standard Bible*.²

²⁶Then God said, "Let Us make man in Our image, according to Our likeness; and let them rule over the fish of the sea and over the birds of the sky and over the cattle and over all the earth, and over every creeping thing that creeps on the earth." ²⁷God created man in His own image, in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them. ²⁸God blessed them; and

God said to them, “Be fruitful and multiply, and fill the earth, and subdue it; and rule over the fish of the sea and over the birds of the sky and over every living thing that moves on the earth.”

Take a deep breath.

First, we see in this passage that all human beings are created in God’s image—men and women, boys and girls. Both sexes reveal the image of God. Human beings were designed to offer to this world the likeness of God’s character, trustworthiness, and creative wealth. We are not designed to mold ourselves into an image that we then worship and serve.

Next, we see in this passage that we have work to do. In the **KF Introductory Meeting**, we learned that Jesus glorified God by finishing His work, and we glorify God by finishing ours. Our job is to rule over other creatures and to subdue the material world. In other words, we are called to influence this world according to God’s mercy and truth. Note that we were not designed to rule over each other. That feels a little scary for the neurotic!

Finally, we are designed to be fruitful and multiply. Our ability to create other eternal souls is similar to God’s creative ability. However, unlike God, we cannot do it alone; we need a partner. Sex differences reveal the nature of our relationship with God. Paul teaches that the communion between male and female in the marriage relationship represents and explores the communion that human creatures have with Christ. ³ This is so important. The unity of one sex with the other reflects our unity with a Divine Being quite different from ourselves but with similar characteristics. Just as we cannot generate children by ourselves, so we cannot be saved or be complete by ourselves. We need to co-labor with God in our own restoration; we cannot do it alone. Only He knows what our glory will look like.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Lord of Glory, I am ready to explore my glory. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are so grateful for this time together. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You guide us to our glory and to the truth. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self, with the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen